

GREAT STUDENT/GREAT TEACHER

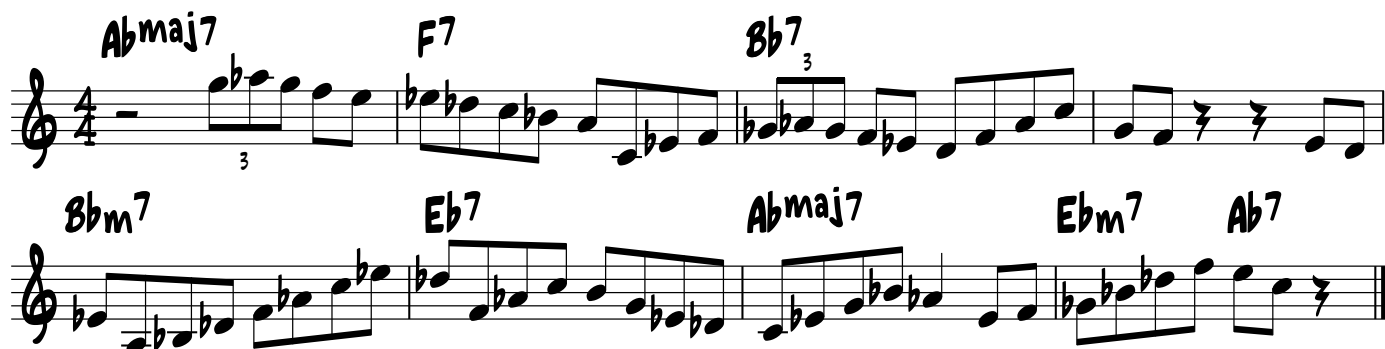
FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #197

At the end of the day, getting good at jazz (or anything in life) is all about just two things.

- 1) Knowing how to teach yourself, how to analyze and fix the challenges you face.
- 2) Knowing when to reach out for help, because you are going to need it. Daily.

And there it is. Why do music majors at great universities generally get better quicker than adult amateurs or semi-pros doing it on their own? Because the music major gets daily input on their work (#2), and through that process, learns how to adjust on the fly better themselves (#1). Olympic skiers, cardiac surgeons, your mechanic . . . they all receive regular input from their colleagues and mentors, managers and coaches (#2), which helps them build their problem solving skills (#1). The path is clear. Find a great coach (#2) to help you become a great coach to yourself (#1). You'll get far better, far quicker.

#1 - "Donna Lee" by Charlie Parker (or Miles Davis)



#2 - Measure 5, practicing the hard part



Locate the "hard part," and do your best to figure out what it making it hard. *Exactly which note or notes?* It likely isn't all of them.

#3 - Measures 29 and 30, practicing the hard part



Demystify the tricky chord changes by loopng them, repeating them over and over. Chord tones, voice leading, vocabulary, function, resolutions . . .